

Tyler Lindow

Engineering Manager | Fintech Platform & 0→1 | Ex-Founder

San Diego, CA | Open to relocation

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SUMMARY

Fintech engineering manager who grew Affirm's developer-support engineering from 1 to 9 engineers and turned it into a software engineering team (Merchant Advocacy Engineering), then led it on Merchant Portal. 6+ years at Affirm across Partner Engineering and marketing products, including leading the developer-support engineering team supporting Affirm's flagship partner integration with Amazon. Ex-founder (Beginner Work Inc.). Targeting Engineering Manager / Senior EM roles in fintech (payments, platform/DevX, partner integrations).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder | Beginner Work Inc.

San Diego, CA | Mar 2026 – Jul 2026

- Built and launched a fundraising pitch simulator (React/Next.js) as sole founder; owned product discovery, architecture, and GTM. Validated demand through 92 in-person conversations (including 5 VCs) and 28 early users.
- Wound down in Jul 2026 rather than raise; personal runway could not cover a full fundraising cycle.

Software Engineering Manager (L7), Merchant Advocacy | Affirm

San Diego, CA (Remote) | Mar 2025 – Feb 2026

- **Scope:** Led the former developer-support team as Merchant Advocacy Engineering (6 engineers), a product engineering team partnering with Product, Design, and Content. Owned Merchant Portal (React, TypeScript), the API-key and transaction-view surface for merchants integrated via ecommerce platforms or direct API.
- **Support-to-engineering transition:** Hired a SWE I and onboarded a Staff SWE and a contractor. Kept taking Tier-2 escalations, but in an advisory role: coached Tier-2 support to self-serve in Snowflake and work directly with the ecommerce platform teams where most issues started. That cut the team's requirement-translation work and moved 50%+ of its time to building in the codebase.
- **Merchant Portal reliability:** Raised availability 99.7% → 99.9% in one quarter by clearing long-standing bugs and errant or mislabeled 5xx status codes, unblocking an Intuit launch covering hundreds of thousands of new merchants; ran weekly AI-tooling sessions to find and remove unused code paths.
- **People leadership:** Raised the performance bar mid-role, reshaping a 9-engineer team to 6: managed two underperformers (one a below-level tech lead) through Poland's labor-law termination process and moved one engineer to a better-fit team. Then moved the team to Kanban with incidents always at the top of the board, which cut confusion in check-ins and got more work delivered on time.

Developer Support Engineering Manager (L6 → L7), Partner Engineering | Affirm

San Diego, CA (Remote) | Jul 2021 – Mar 2025

- **Support to software engineering:** Set the goal of turning developer support into a software engineering team: grew the function from 1 to 9 engineers, owned interview rubrics and early-team hiring decisions, and shifted Tier-1/Tier-2 load to operations so the team could become the Merchant Advocacy software engineering team.
- **Amazon, flagship partner:** Led the developer-support engineering team for Affirm's flagship partner, Amazon, across checkout and confirmation-flow integrations via partner REST APIs and webhooks; with Sales Engineers, Technical Writers, and plugin partners, delivered the Snowflake-based availability report that kept Affirm in compliance with Amazon partnership requirements.
- **People development:** Delivered 2 promotions, including a junior engineer to intermediate in ~1 year who then moved into product-building engineering. Ran monthly career-growth reviews across the 9-engineer team.
- **Observability:** Built per-merchant dashboards and alerting that cut detection time for higher-volume merchant-scoped outages to under 5 minutes (previously 20 minutes–2 hours unnoticed).

Developer Support Engineer (L4 → L5), Partner Engineering | Affirm

San Francisco, CA (Hybrid) | Sep 2019 – Jul 2021

- **Merchant checkout integrations:** Promoted L4→L5. Primary technical liaison for 300+ SMB merchants; diagnosed JavaScript, REST API, and webhook defects in checkout / payment-method integrations on Shopify, Magento, WooCommerce, and Salesforce Commerce Cloud.
- **DevX feedback loop:** Built ETL pipelines into Snowflake to cluster integration-defect patterns and convert developer feedback into platform fixes that reduced ticket inbound rate ~20% quarter over quarter.

Lead Software Engineering Immersive Resident | Galvanize Inc

San Francisco, CA | May 2019 – Aug 2019

- Directed technical onboarding and multi-repo code review for ~20 Hack Reactor students (full-stack JavaScript, Git).

Experience Development Specialist & Prototyping Studio Coordinator | The Tech Interactive

San Jose, CA | May 2017 – Jan 2019

- Partnered with Google on sensor-API workshops for 400+ visitors; engineered generative workshop signage in JavaScript (p5.js); Monthly Innovator Award.

Design Code Build Instructor | Computer History Museum

Mountain View, CA | Mar 2017 – Nov 2018

- Guided 1,000+ students and volunteers through software logic and physical computing workshops.

EDUCATION

- **Northwestern University** | Learning Sciences graduate coursework (Evanston, IL)
- **University of California, San Diego** | B.S. NanoEngineering, *Cum Laude* (La Jolla, CA)
- **Software engineering:** Hack Reactor Advanced Software Engineering Immersive; Deep Atlas Applied AI & ML residency
- Additional: Olin College of Engineering SEER (Summer Engineering Education Research)

SKILLS & TOOLKITS

- **Technical Toolkit:** Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, Flask, Snowflake, SQL, ETL Pipelines, REST APIs, Webhooks, CI/CD, Git/GitHub, observability, LLMs & agentic coding (Claude, Cursor)
- **Leadership & Management:** Performance management & promotions, org design / domain boundaries, mentorship, incident management
- **B2B Integrations & Operations:** Partner Engineering, merchant checkout integrations (Shopify, Magento, WooCommerce, SFCC), Merchant Portal